

BRAND BIBLE · V1 · MILESTONE 1 OF 10

RoutePadi

The padi who already knows the shortcut
— community-verified transit routes for
Ibadan, built to feel like local knowledge,
not a startup template.

FRIENDLY · LOCAL · COMMUNITY-DRIVEN · HELPFUL · YOUTHFUL · TRUSTWORTHY ·
NEVER CORPORATE

This is a living document. It captures what's locked in through the brand
strategy pass so far — palette, type, illustration rules, and the badge roster.
Logo directions are in review below; the full component library and social
templates follow in later milestones and will fold back in here too.

01.1 Why we're rebuilding the look

The current build reads as generic SaaS, not Ibadan: a pale mint header, thin
grey-bordered inputs, a bold-but-characterless sans, and a green-to-yellow
gradient reused on both the "Find Route" and "Contribute Route" buttons. Strip
the wordmark and it could be any transit, fintech, or scheduling app. Nothing
signals community, youth, or Nigeria — and the gradient is the clearest tell.

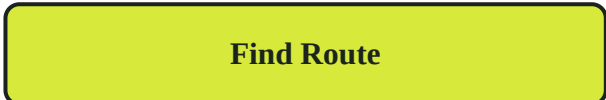
BEFORE — LIVE TODAY



Find Route

linear-gradient, green → yellow — soft,
template-default, no edge

AFTER — BRAND DIRECTION



Find Route

flat chartreuse, charcoal outline —
confident, poster-flat, no blend

02 Logo

The live mark today is a circular "RP" monogram in a green-to-teal gradient — the same generic-template problem as the buttons, one level up. Concept B went two refinement rounds (a decorated road, then a dark coin with a dotted laneline) and never quite closed the gap. Concept A wins instead — and it was already the systemic pick: the exact route-pin object from the illustration system and badge roster, now doing a third job as the logo.

Concept A

LOCKED



Padi Pin

The exact route-pin object already established in the illustration system and reused across the badge roster. Nothing new to maintain — the logo is the same shape people already see everywhere in the product.

Concept B



Padi Path — not chosen

Two rounds: a decorated road-bend icon, then a dark coin with a dotted laneline. Both got closer to "professional" but neither beat the case for reusing an object the product already relies on elsewhere. Kept here for the record, not carried forward.

Concept C

RoutePadi

Wordmark Only

No icon to design or maintain, and Bricolage Grotesque is distinctive enough to carry it alone. The tradeoff: something square still has to represent the app on a home screen or browser tab, and a lone "R" monogram reintroduces the exact generic-monogram problem we're moving away from.

SCALE & VERSATILITY TEST — CONCEPT A, LOCKED



App icon



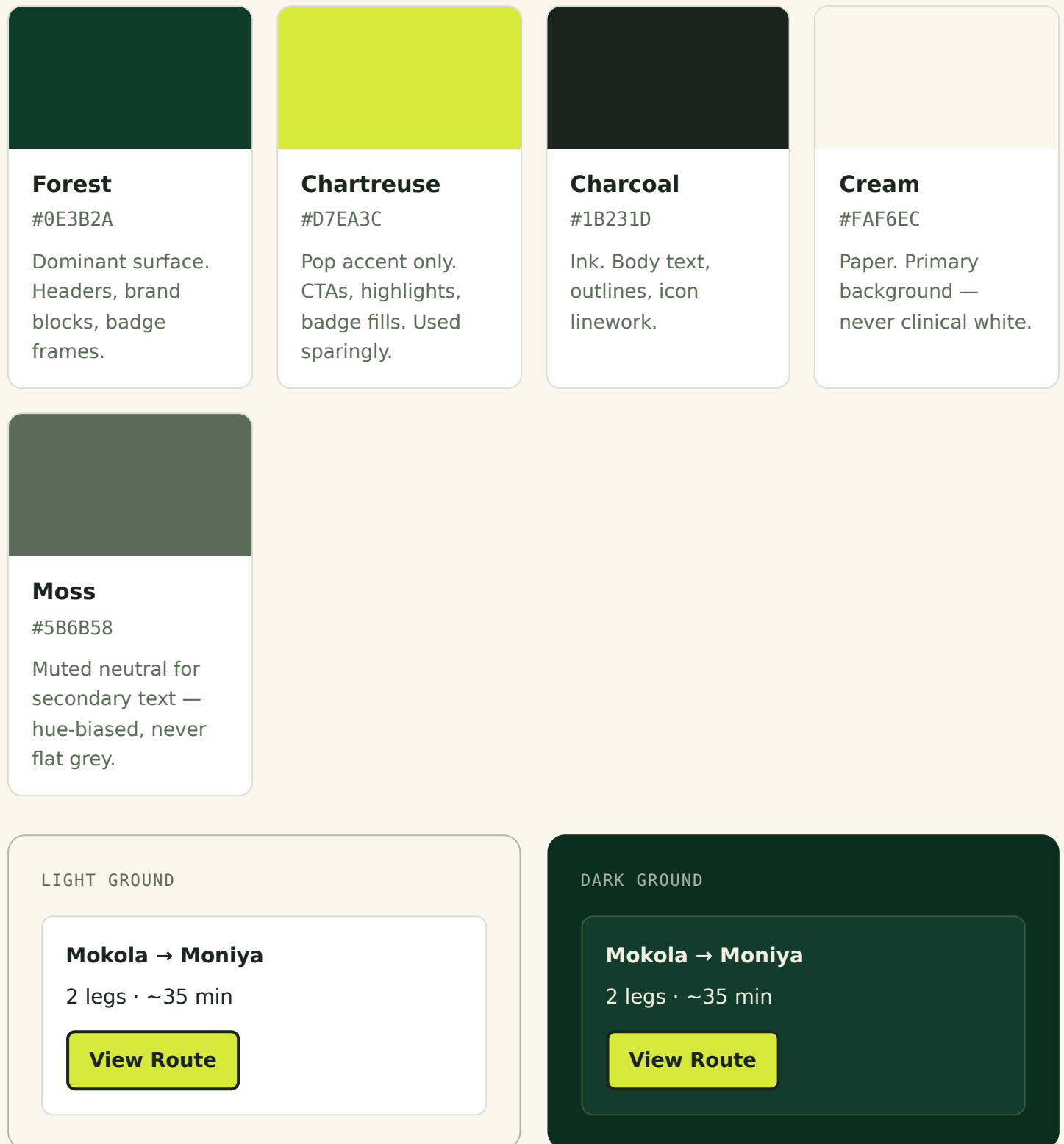
Favicon / avatar crop



Single-color knockout

03 Color

A strict duotone core — four colors, no more — so the brand stays recognizable at a glance on X. Gamification tiers (bronze / silver / gold) get their own expanded palette in Milestone 4; they are deliberately not added here.



04 Type

Two roles, plus a utility face for data. Headlines carry the personality; body text stays boring-legible on purpose — it'll be read at a bus stop, in direct sun, on a cracked screen.

Board at UI Gate

BODY — PLUS JAKARTA SANS 400/500

From Mokola to Moniya: take a taxi to UI Gate, then board another taxi going to Moniya. Expected fare: ~~N700~~—~~N900~~.

UTILITY — SPACE MONO 400/700

+10 XP · route contribution · 970 XP to Route Commander

05 Illustration System

No mascot — a closed roster of recurring objects instead, so art direction stays a fixed checklist rather than a character needing a pose in every scene. Two render techniques, one rule set underneath.

01 Flat fills only

One or two colors max, pulled only from the core palette plus charcoal/cream. No gradients, ever — that's the one rule everything else exists to protect.

02 Consistent thick outline

Every object gets the same relative stroke weight, heavy enough to read at thumbnail size on X.

03 Offset sticker-shadow

A solid duplicate silhouette sits behind each object, same direction and distance every time — this single detail is what ties flat-sticker UI art to pixel badge art as one family.

04 Two techniques, one vocabulary

UI and social content render flat and unframed. Badges render pixelated inside a shared rounded-square frame with a tier ring. Same object, same colors, different technique for different context.



Route pin — core UI icon

06 Badge Roster

Mapped 1:1 to the six achievements already live on routepadi.com — nothing invented, nothing left over. Rendered as hand-authored pixel sprites (not smooth flat icons) — the retro/arcade texture the brief asked for, built from the same duotone palette as everything else.



First Ride

Unlocked on your first route submission

Object: keke — the vehicle of someone's very first logged journey.



Fare Whisperer

Submit 3 routes

Object: naira coin stack — knowing the real fare before you board.



Street Guardian

Submit 5 routes

Object: shield — safety and route trustworthiness.



Area Commander

Submit 10 routes

Object: flag on a pin — territory earned through volume.



City Explorer

Reach 2,500 XP

Object: compass — discovery earned through sustained contribution.



Master Scout

Reach 5,000 XP

Object: crown — the top tier, reserved for the highest XP bar.

Now designed and scheduled, not deferred anymore: the handshake badge for **OG Padi** is built — see [Launch Campaign](#) for the object and the rule that protects it. Deliberately kept out of the roster grid above: it's a one-time launch-window badge, not a repeatable achievement, and mixing it in with "submit 5 routes" style badges would blur that distinction.

Out of scope for this pass: the rank ladder (Route Scout → Route Commander), which is a single evolving title rather than a collectible, and the leaderboard's top-3 treatment — both intentionally deferred.

Core duotone palette	LOCKED
Typography pairing	LOCKED
Illustration rule system	LOCKED
Badge object roster (6)	LOCKED
Logo (Concept A, Padi Pin)	LOCKED
Pixel badge art, all 6 sprites	LOCKED
Full component library (Design System)	LOCKED
Social media templates (Milestone 5)	LOCKED
Content strategy (Milestone 6)	LOCKED
OG Padi badge & launch campaign (Milestone 7)	LOCKED
Gamification tier colors (bronze/silver/gold)	DEFERRED
Rank ladder visual treatment	DEFERRED
Leaderboard top-3 treatment	DEFERRED

Logo and badge art locked. The component library lives in its own doc — [RoutePadi Design System](#) — buttons, cards, inputs, navigation, empty and loading states, applied straight onto the real home screen live on routepadi.com today. The badge sprites show up outside the product too, in [Social Media Templates](#) and get an actual posting rhythm in [Content Strategy](#). The reserved OG Padi badge finally has a reason to exist in [Launch Campaign](#). Next up: Milestone 8, Marketing Assets.